

CAMBRIDGE JUDGE

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT CAMBRIDGE JUDGE

Cambridge Judge Business School is the business school of the University of Cambridge, one of the oldest – and most prestigious – universities in the world. With just 200 students per year, the programme is considerably smaller than its main rival, Saïd Business School at the University of Oxford. And, at 12 months, it's an accelerated alternative to the UK's leading MBA programme at London Business School.

Like Oxford, Cambridge operates within the unique college system. There are 31 colleges at the University of Cambridge, and most MBA students will be admitted to a specific college as well as to the MBA programme itself, providing a further network, social and learning opportunities with students studying an array of other courses.

With its close proximity to London and the Silicon Roundabout and its own accelerator, Cambridge is known particularly for its strengths in entrepreneurship and innovation, although a sizeable portion of the class exits onto more “traditional” post-MBA career paths such as finance and consulting.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALISATIONS

Entrepreneurship, Finance, Organizational Behaviour, Corporate
Strategy, Healthcare

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	-	-	5	-	-	6	5	7
Financial Times	8	5	6	-	-	2	4	5
Forbes	-	8	-	-	-	4	-	3
The Economist	13	9	16	-	-	13	10	12
US News	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

CLASS OF 2020 ADMISSIONS

MBA Class Size	174
Average Age	29
Average GMAT	687
Average GPA	3.43
Total Tuition	£59,000

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Consulting	29%
Financial Services	23%
Industry	44%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Amazon, Deloitte, Genpact, Google, McKinsey & Company

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: £73,227
EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 94%

*Rankings are relative to other non -U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR CAMBRIDGE JUDGE APPLICATION

BY KAREN PONTE

Fortuna Admissions expert coach Karen Ponte is former Senior Program Manager at London Business School. She brings extensive experience reviewing admission files at a number of top programs, from LBS and INSEAD to Imperial, Oxford, Cambridge, Warwick, and IMD.



**Judge wants its graduates to go out into
the world and make a difference.**

1

UNDERSTAND THE IMPORTANCE OF ACADEMICS

Cambridge University has an 800-year reputation for academic excellence – demonstrate your understanding of this by clearly communicating your thirst for learning. If you have a strong academic track record, be proud of this and showcase it. If you have struggled in the past or don't feel your academic history is a true reflection of who you are (or your potential) then be clear on this. Show your ability to self-reflect and your progression since those earlier days. Judge wants bright, ambitious individuals – but is aware that not all intelligence is always clear on paper – so if there is a story to tell here, then be sure to tell it.

DEMONSTRATE YOUR GLOBAL OUTLOOK

2

An average MBA class at Judge will include students from around 40 different nationalities. The programme encourages a global outlook and for its graduates to embrace an internationally focused career. It also wants students to come to the programme with some international work experience and this global vision. If you've worked in a variety of countries, be sure to explain this – and be clear on why this has been important, what you have gained and why this is key to your future career. If you have limited international work experience to date, then consider showcasing your travels, your wider networks (friends, family, etc. in other countries) – anything that has allowed you to broaden your horizons and gain an understanding of the world. Allow the admissions committee an insight into your passion for a globally-focused career; what inspired this in you? Why is it key to your ambitions and goals? How does this passion make you a more rounded and valuable MBA student?

3

SHOW YOUR AMBITION AND YOUR PASSION

Judge wants its graduates to go out into the world and make a difference, to make a positive impact through business. Show that you have this drive, this focus and that you want to create a legacy to be proud of. Be clear on your career progression to date, show how you've overcome any obstacles that have been in your way (personally or professionally) and that you have a clear vision for your future. Show how you've been able to work in demanding environments and have excelled and be clear that your future goals encompass not only your own successes, but also the impact your career will have on others.

BE CLEAR ON YOUR SOFT SKILLS

4

Solid work experience is important for Judge and on average, students will have around six years of experience when they enter the programme. However, your ability to communicate, collaborate, and innovate are more important than just your job titles. Use examples to show that you have the confidence to speak up, to lead when necessary, but also to work well with others, learn from others and be inspired by them. Make your story more than just a re-write of your CV - instead, show the kinds of skills your career has given you. How has a tough team situation made you more empathetic? More resilient? More confident? How have your early leadership experiences helped you grow? Given you greater self-awareness? Inspired you? When have you been forced to innovate to solve a problem? How has this enriched you and those around you? Really offer insight into you as a person - and what you will ultimately bring to the programme to share with others.

5

EXPLAIN 'WHY CAMBRIDGE?'

With so many MBA programmes available, Judge Admissions want to know why you're applying to them. What is it about the programme that makes it the perfect fit for you? Prove that you've done thoughtful research; reach out to current students and alums to show that you understand the importance of community right from the outset and appreciate the unique offerings of the programme (and why these are key for you). Cambridge is proud of its college system and all MBA students become part of one of the colleges (with most choosing to live within the college) - this is a unique feature of the programme and enables students to diversify their networks and learn from individuals from a wide variety of disciplines. This has often led to interesting, innovative ideas and projects - which is at the heart of what the Judge MBA hopes to inspire and encourage. Convey that you understand this element of the Judge experience.

ESSAYS

For in-depth essay analysis visit the Fortuna
[Blog](#).



DEADLINES & DATES

ROUND	APPLICATION DEADLINE
1	7 September 2020
2	19 October 2020
3	11 January 2021
4	8 March 2021
5	26 April 2021

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**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, MIT Sloan, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

